



PHOTO BY **MANDAR DEODHAR**

out to encourage large-scale electronics manufacturing. India was also an attractive alternative due to availability of manufacturing skills at scale.

“PLI built the runway, but Apple’s supply chain diversification gave the take-off, real velocity,” says Varun Gupta, co-founder, GOBOULT, a wearables and audio brand. India’s hi-tech electronics manufacturing boom is a result of focused policy actions combined with structural global shifts. “The government created a framework through PLI which reduced entry risk and enabled large-scale commitments by global lead firms,” says Pankaj Mohindroo, chairman, Indian Cellular and Electronics Association (ICEA).

The PLI scheme for electronics was launched with an initial outlay of ₹40,951

crore. As of March 2026, the government had disbursed around ₹18,000 crore as incentives to companies. Apple’s vendors — Foxconn, Pegatron and Wistron, whose India operations were later acquired by Tata Electronics—have helped it build scale.

Today, Apple has five iPhone factories in India (in Tamil Nadu and Karnataka), alongside a domestic supply chain of around 45 companies. The ecosystem has generated more than 250,000 direct jobs, according to data submitted by vendors to MeitY, and an estimated 750,000 indirect jobs. “Incentives obviously are required to build and scale up the ecosystem. The government has done a good job with PLI,” Raina said, on being asked whether the industry would have scaled without PLI.

GO BIG

Customers during the opening of Apple’s first retail store in India at Bandra Kurla Complex in Mumbai, on April 18, 2023